

Ash glazes – the mountain series

Started spring 2025. Local Kyoto mountain ash, washed and unwashed. Cone 10 reduction unless noted.

The whole point of this series is the ash I gather myself off the Kitayama slopes after the brush burns, plus the temple pine that Mika saves for me from the anagama stoke pile. Bought ash is even and dead. Gathered ash is uneven and alive, and the unevenness is the work. Wash twice for a cleaner blue, leave it unwashed for the rougher green break. Everything here is a base 40 ash, 40 feldspar, 20 local clay, then I move from there. Percentages below are by dry weight. These are mine. Do not pass them on.

Mountain ash green (house glaze, batch 4)

washed twice. the one I reach for.

Kitayama wood ash (washed)	40
Custer feldspar	38
local stoneware clay	17
red iron oxide	3
whiting	2

read: Green that breaks lighter on the rims. Batch 4 greener than batch 2, I think the autumn ash is higher in the brush iron. Keep gathering autumn ash. Even break, no crawling at this thickness.

Nuka white (batch 7)

rice straw ash white. soft and milky.

rice straw ash	30
Custer feldspar	30
silica	20
local clay	18
whiting	2

read: Milky white, a little blue where it pools. Thins too far on sharp rims and shows the clay. Note for next batch: 2 percent less water in the bucket, it was running.

Ash celadon

washed ash, longer settle. for the wells and the platters.

Kitayama wood ash (washed 3x)	35
feldspar	35
silica	15
local clay	13
bone ash	2

read: Soft blue grey, pools beautiful in the platter wells and the jug interiors. Needs depth to read, useless thin.

Test tile observations

Tiles fired alongside production. Numbered on the back in iron. See the tile board photo for the grid.

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| T-41 | Mtn green, 1 dip
<i>read: clean, classic, the control</i> |
| T-42 | Mtn green, 2 dips
<i>read: pools dark in the wells, like it on bowls</i> |
| T-43 | Mtn green + 1% cobalt
<i>read: too blue, lost the ash character. no.</i> |
| T-44 | Nuka over iron slip
<i>read: beautiful soft edge where they meet. explore this.</i> |
| T-45 | Unwashed ash, raw
<i>read: rough green, lots of pinhole. wood fire only.</i> |
| T-46 | Celadon, thick
<i>read: the blue I want. needs the well to hold it.</i> |
| T-47 | Kaki iron red, thick
<i>read: persimmon. cracked thin, must go thick.</i> |
| T-48 | Tenmoku, standard
<i>read: reliable. rust break on the edge, good.</i> |
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Direction for the autumn anagama: take T-44 and T-46 to scale. The nuka over iron slip is the surface I have been chasing since the Shigaraki years. Toshio did something close on his tea bowls and never told me the trick. Maybe there is no trick, maybe it is just the slip and the patience. Save three good tea bowls from this run for his birthday piece thinking.